52. BL/IOR/L/PS/11/130/170/1918, Marling to Foreign Office, 12 Jan. 1918; TNA/FO371/3858/13066, Lieutenant-Colonel Grey, Indian Agent Khorasan, to Government of India, 27 Sept. 1918. All of Bravin's communications with Russia were being intercepted and read by the British. Chaqueri, The Soviet Socialist Republic of Iran, 1920–1921: Birth of the Trauma , p. 147 (hereafter Birth of a Trauma).

53. TNA/FO248/1213, Bravin to Chicherin, 19 June 1918.

54. Dailami, 'Bravin', p. 74.

55. Von Laue, 'Soviet Diplomacy: G.V. Chicherin, Peoples Commissar for Foreign Affairs, 1918–1930', in Craig and Gilbert, op. cit., p. 235.

56. Blank, 'Soviet Politics and the Iranian Revolution of 1919–1921, Cahiers du Monde russe et soviétique, Vol. 21 (1980), pp. 173–94.

57. Bravin was a supporter of the Jangalis ('Forest People'), a group of revolutionary Persians based in the north of the country at Gilan and led by Kuchik Khan who, since 1914, had agitated for a continuation for the Constitutional Revolution which had begun in 1905 in Persia, but had been suppressed in 1911 by Tsarist Russia. Dailami, 'Bravin', pp. 75–8. In July 1920 at the Second Congress of the Comintern this issue of whether the Bolsheviks should support 'bourgeois nationalist' movements would be the central feature. For more, see Chapter Three.

58. During 1921 the Soviet government would negotiate a number of treaties with different nations, including Persia, Afghanistan, Turkey and Britain (see Chapter Four). Meanwhile, Bravin would be recalled from Tehran in June 1918 and sent to Kabul. His replacement, I.O. Kolomytsev would have just as little success in Persia as Bravin, and was forced to leave in November 1918 when the Soviet legation was attacked by the Cossack Division. In August 1919 Kolomytsev would be murdered by the Whites as he tried to return to Persia. Volodarsky, op. cit., pp. 21–4. Not until April 1921, when Theodore Rothstein arrived, would the Soviet government have a professional representative in Persia.